

Critically analyze/evaluate how much time was spent learning syntax & structure, programming concepts vs. actually programming, and how does this reflect on the final quality of your end result.

- I actually think I have a good conceptual understanding of programming and how it works, it just gets confusing with the syntax. A lot of my time was honestly spent trying to remember specific formatting rules and how functions are structured. Once I understood the logic behind something, I usually understood the purpose of it pretty quickly. I think this reflects in my final project because conceptually I knew what I wanted to achieve, but sometimes the technical execution took longer than expected because I had to work through the specific syntax. Even so, I think the final result still reflects a good basic grasp of programming and what I can do with it.

• Comment on your successes and frustrations with Processing and P5.js.

- Frustrations: It feels a bit outdated and niche to me. As someone who is not a programmer, it's a nice thing to know and be able to use, but I wonder about its applicability in the real world. Sometimes it also felt limiting or unintuitive, and I would often get frustrated working on my projects as someone who inherently struggles with syntax.

- Successes: So much more fun than Python! It is a lot more visual and interactive, which made the learning process more engaging by far. Being able to immediately see what you're coding made it feel more creative and connected to design rather than just technical. I also liked how accessible it was for experimentation, since I could quickly test ideas and visually understand what my code was doing.

• Compare and contrast OOP versus Procedural Programming. How are they similar? How are they different? I am looking for you to explain this in your own words, what these concepts are. I am NOT looking for you to tell me how you used these in your project.

- To me, procedural programming feels more like giving a computer a list of instructions in a sequential manner. I assign functions and variables, and the program runs through them one by one. OOP feels more like building a system out of individual things that each contain their own behaviors and rules. It's great for creating repeating patterns and having complex code turned into a system that gets reused.

• Specifically considering your final project: What programming concepts solidified in your final project? What did you learn with reference to programming? Did you have a breakthrough?

- I wanted to give OOP another chance and finally got a good-ish grasp of it. It was good to try it again and learn it all over again in order to really understand it. It was also really cool to try computer vision (and surprisingly easy). I really enjoyed giving that a go and would like to use it in the future, because people are always impressed with responsive projects.

- Specifically considering your final project: Were you able to resolve your own bugs? What tricks did you learn in the process to help? Did you do any debugging?

- I didn't necessarily have major bugs, but I definitely had moments where things would not work the way I expected. Usually the issue came down to syntax or small logic mistakes. I learned that debugging is mostly about patience and isolating the problem one step at a time. Printing values, simplifying sections of code, and testing things incrementally helped a lot. I also realized that taking a break and coming back later sometimes made the solution immediately obvious.

- What was your intended milestone? Did you make it? Did another one pop up? Tell me about this. Tell me how you resolved it.

- My intended milestone was to create an interactive project that combined coding with physical computing in a way that felt engaging and functional. I think I achieved that overall, but had to eliminate the physical computing aspect because of my own mistake (forgetting my arduino in a locked room). I resolved this by simply focusing on the idea and just using p5.js to communicate the concept instead of using the Arduino and communicating between them.

- What are you most proud of, with reference to your final project?

- I am most proud of my attempt at physical computing. I am most proud of my attempt at physical computing. Since I do not really come from a programming background, combining fabrication with code felt intimidating at first. Even though it was challenging, I'm proud that I was able to create something interactive and experimental that connected programming with my design interests.

- How do you think you'll move forward with programming? will you keep doing it ? How does this relate to other classes you are either taking or wish to take?

- I'm completely done with classes as of now! As a graphic designer, I have a hard time imagining myself programming again, considering that I don't really have an affinity for it. Even if I do not continue programming directly, I think understanding the logic behind it will still help me collaborate with developers and approach design projects more thoughtfully in the future.